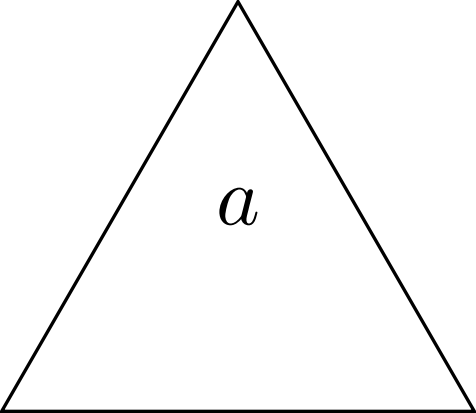
$a$